international conference where the issue of desertification on a global scale was addressed. The outcome of this conference was the Plan of Action to Combat Desertification.

8. *Water Conference 1977:* This United Nations Water Conference was held in Mar del Plata, Argentina from 14 to 25 March, 1977. This Conference recognized the central role of water in public health and environmental planning. Freshwater issues were thus discussed and that too in the context of sustainable development. It also recognized that:

- global climate change could affect freshwater resources and the hydrological cycle through higher temperatures and decreased precipitation leading to decreased water supplies and increased demand for water;
- increases in climate extremes, such as floods or droughts, could further stress water resources;
- a sea level rise would put low-lying countries at risk; and
- atmospheric pollutants could affect freshwater resources.

The Conference recommended a number of measures/techniques that the international community can develop and apply in assessing the potential adverse effects of the above.

9. *World Climate Conference, Geneva, 1979:* The World Climate Conferences actually are a series of international meetings organized by the World Meteorological Organization (WMO) on global climate issues. The **First World Climate Conference** was held on 12–23 February 1979 in Geneva and it focused on the increasing emission of carbon dioxide resulting in “greenhouse” effect. The outcome of this Conference was the establishment of the World Climate Programme (WCP), the World Climate Research Programme and the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) by WMO and UNEP in 1988. The **Second World Climate Conference** was held from 29 October to 7 November 1990, Geneva. The notable feature of this Conference was the establishment of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCC) amidst differences over climate change